



CONTRACTOR OF THE YEAR ASSESSMENT GUIDE

Evaluation Framework for the Project Contractor of the Year (PCoTY) Award 2027

For Stage 1 assessors and Stage 2 judges.

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INTRODUCTION

This is the Evaluation Framework for the Project Contractor of the Year (PCoTY) Award 2027. It is the formal guide for a rigorous, transparent, and consistent review of every nomination.

The cycle looks for contractors who move **beyond competence toward excellence**: not only fulfilling the contract, but transforming practice through novel approaches, pioneering techniques, and measurable impact others can learn from.

Customer evaluation is separate. Clients score seven operational dimensions on a **0-10 weighted scale**. You score the **nine award criteria on a 1-10 scale** (same range as the portal sliders). Do not convert one into the other.

YOUR JOB

Independently score assigned nominations on **nine criteria (1-10)** with a justification on each. Finish by the deadline.

You do: confirm conflict of interest, read the packet (and the customer evaluation if it is available to you), score, comment, submit.

You do not: run eligibility or completeness checks (intake and admins gate that), coach nominees, or share scores with nominees.

Conflict of interest: if you have a conflict, stop and contact the organisers for reassignment. Do not score that nomination.

There is **no Nominee Coach**. Questions go to organisers or admin.

SCORING SCALE

Sliders on the Assessor Dashboard and Calibration Exam are **minimum 1, maximum 10, step 1**.

Score	Meaning
1	Not demonstrated / missing evidence
2	Poor
3-4	Fair
5-6	Good
7-8	Very good
9-10	Excellent

Nine criteria, 10 maximum each. **90 is the highest** a nomination can receive from one assessor or judge.

At least **two independent reviews** per nomination (target three when capacity allows). If two assessors differ by **more than 4 points** on a criterion, the Project Manager moderates. Discuss evidence, not ego.

1 is not a moral judgement. It means the packet did not show it. 5-6 is solid professional work. 9-10 is exceptional and evidenced. Do not save 10 for "someone else". If the evidence is there, give it.

THE NINE CRITERIA

Score each one. A comment is required.

#	Criterion	Look for	Ask
1	Project Success (outcomes)	Delivery vs baseline; benefits; handover; measurable impact and transformation	Did they deliver? What lasting impact?
2	Agility and Adaptability	Change control; fit to the contracting model (including T&M cash and visibility)	How did they handle change without chaos?
3	Commercial Model (liquidity)	Price realism; milestones; advances and retentions; liquidity on both sides; supply-chain payment	Fair cash flow for both parties? Was the price real?
4	Legal Soundness	Law and jurisdiction; warranty and liability; privity; fit to the collaboration model	Complete, enforceable, suited to the model?
5	Interface and Governance	Customer-contractor boundary; escalation; decision rights	Clear boundary and working governance?
6	Risk Management (cross-corporate)	Cross-party financial, ops, IP, cyber, regulatory, reputational, geopolitical risks and mitigations	Risks identified and mitigated across the interface?
7	People Development	Investment as % of profit: 0 / 0-5 / 5%+; training and certification evidence	Real investment with delivery impact?
8	Team and Business Acumen	Leadership; candour; initiative; customer vs profit balance; code of conduct; anti-corruption; transparency	Integrity and leadership under pressure?
9	Innovation and Industry Advancement	Novelty; industry contribution; knowledge sharing; case-study worth	Would we publish this? Winners typically 8-10 here.

Notes on selected criteria

Agility (2), T&M contracts. Consider billing frequency vs contractor cash-flow needs, rate transparency, client cost visibility, and whether change control stays compatible with the project objectives.

Commercial model (3). Price realism and whether money reached the people doing the work. A lowball bid is not a discount; it is a wild-card invoice you have not received yet. Overpricing is the same problem later. Fragile supply-chain payment is a commercial failure, not only a procurement footnote.

People development (7). Categories are 0%, 0-5%, or 5%+ of net income or profit invested in staff development (technical, organisational, or commercial). Higher investment usually correlates with better delivery and a more capable customer relationship. A 0% with no other evidence of development is a red flag, not a neutral score.

Team and business acumen (8). Candour (raising what would turn green to amber) and initiative (bringing a better way, not only executing the ticket) sit beside integrity and leadership.

Innovation (9). This is the filter that distinguishes winners from competent performers. High scores on delivery or legal soundness are not enough.

CRITERION 9 IN DETAIL

Use these descriptors when scoring Innovation and Industry Advancement:

Score	Descriptor
1	Not demonstrated / missing evidence
2	Poor. Standard approach, no innovation, no industry contribution
3-4	Fair. Some novel elements, minor improvements, limited knowledge sharing
5-6	Good. Solid innovation, some industry relevance, basic knowledge sharing
7-8	Very good. Significant innovation, industry-relevant, active knowledge sharing, replicable practices
9-10	Excellent. Groundbreaking approach, advances the profession, extensive knowledge sharing, highly replicable, case-study worthy

Winners typically score **8-10** on this criterion. A 10 is only for work that is groundbreaking or that advances the profession.

COMMENT TIPS

For each criterion: why this score, strengths, gaps, and pointers to evidence (section or artifact). Be objective, consistent, and constructive.

Credo check for winners: excellence, impact, industry contribution, innovation, legacy. Not merely competent delivery.

Red flags: missing evidence, no measurable impact, generic approach, no knowledge sharing, integrity concerns, 0% people development.

Green flags: clear transformation, real innovation, active sharing, strong cross-party risk and integrity, 5%+ people development, case-study worthy.

Silence in the packet is not neutral. If you find nothing for a criterion, record that you found nothing and score accordingly.

STAGE 1: ASSESSORS

1. Confirm no conflict of interest.
2. Read the nomination packet (narrative, artifacts, and customer evaluation if shown).
3. Score criteria 1-9 (1-10) with a comment on each.
4. Submit by the deadline.

You may be asked to join **moderation** if scores diverge. Do not share scores with nominees. Refer them to the organisers.

Intake has already checked eligibility and completeness. You are scoring quality, not chasing missing files. If a required artifact is genuinely absent, that is evidence for the related criterion, not a reason to reopen intake.

STAGE 2: JUDGING PANEL

Shortlisted nominees present **20 minutes** plus **15 minutes of questions**. They arrive **already in a category** (assigned at intake). The panel does not re-bucket them.

Judges:

- Attend the presentation and Q&A.
- **Rescore all nine criteria independently (1-10)**, with strong attention to Criterion 9.
- Use the customer evaluation and the Q&A as input, not as a substitute for their own scores.
- Join outlier moderation (difference of more than 4 points) and final deliberation.
- Name **three places per category** (Small, Medium, Large) and **one overall** Project Contractor of the Year from the Stage 2 field (normally also a category first place). Empty places stay empty if the field is thin.

Consensus or a moderated average determines those places. In a stalemate, Oliver F. Lehmann has the deciding vote.

Presentations may be recorded and published, subject to consent.

Once assessor and customer numbers are in, the panel still applies a qualitative lens: does this nomination move past standard expectations?

EXEMPLARY ANCHORS

Standard performance (competence)	Exemplary performance (winner)
Competence: did the job very well	Excellence: did something uniquely valuable
Compliance: had good processes	Impact: created measurable, lasting change
Success: the customer was happy	Industry contribution: shared knowledge and advanced the profession
Standards: followed best practices	Innovation: created new best practices
Project completion: finished the project	Legacy: transformed relationships and left a lasting impact

THE CASE-STUDY TEST

The last practical question for the panel:

Would we want to publish this as a case study?

If the project is competent but does not offer lessons others can use, it is unlikely to win, regardless of how high the base delivery scores are.